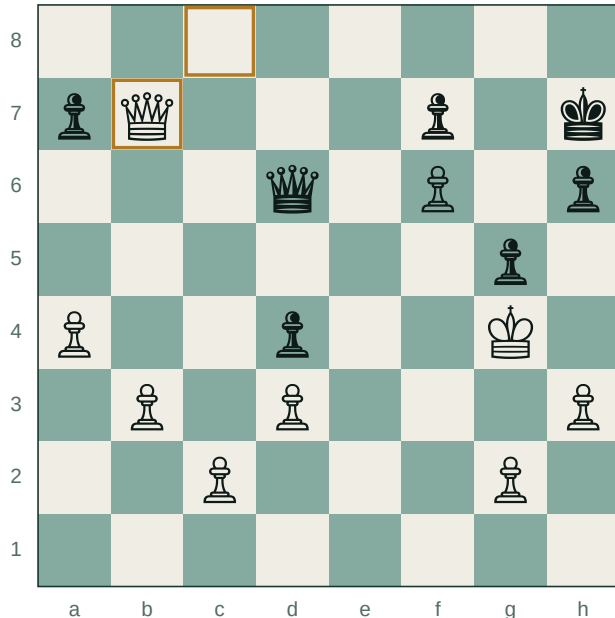


Mate in two: Black, move 37

Mate in two

Black to move



Previous move: 37.Qxb7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37...Qf4+ 38. Kh5 Qh4#

37...Qf4+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **38.Kh5**.

38...Qh4# Mate: queen on h4 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h5. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The displayed line is one recorded defense. Test other legal replies instead of assuming the defender must copy it.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A mating combination must survive the defender's reply. The first move should force a position in which a second move ends the game against every defense.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the likely mating square and the defender that prevents it. Calculate the forcing move that removes that resource.

The defending king is on g4. Geometrically undefended: queen on b7. Check for tactical protection.